



Sapienza Beamer theme

Your Name - ID
Documentation and examples
Sapienza University of Rome





Credits

This theme is a LaTeX Beamer port of the **Sapienza PPT template** by Pietro Nardelli, inspired by the Sapienza NLP Group.

- **Original template:** <https://github.com/pietro-nardelli/sapienza-ppt-template>
- **Original author:** Pietro Nardelli
- **License:** Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 4.0 International (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0)
- **Note:** unofficial, not endorsed by Sapienza University of Rome



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1. Getting started

- Compile with **XeLaTeX** or LuaLaTeX: the theme uses `fontspec`
- Copy `beamerthemeSapienza.sty`, `fonts/` and `img/` next to your `.tex`
- Use `make` for both variants, or run `latexmk -xelatex`
- Run twice: the overlays use `remember picture` (latexmk does it for you)





Minimal document

- `\documentclass[t,aspectratio=169]{beamer}`
- `\usetheme[light]{Sapienza}` (or `[dark]`)
- `\title[Short]{Long title},\author[Short]{Full name}`
- `\subtitle,\institute`

Use the class option `t`: it aligns frame content to the top, as in the original template. The short title and short author are printed in the footer.





Light and dark variants

The variant is a theme option: `\usetheme[dark]{Sapienza}`. Colours are defined once and switch with the option.

- **Accents** (same in both): teal #006778, burgundy #6F0A19
- **Light**: white background, grey text #595959, banner #E9EDEE
- **Dark**: background #353535, text #E9EDEE, banner #595959

To pick the variant from the command line, define `\sapvariant` before the document class, as this deck does (see the Makefile).





2. Slide types

Five layouts, as in the PPT template

Title slide: `\titlepage` in a [plain] frame.

Table of contents: `\sapToc`.

Content slide: a normal frame with a title.

Section slide: `\sapSection`, the one you are looking at.

Closing slide: `\sapClosing`.





Title slide

```
\begin{frame}[plain]\titlepage\end{frame}
```

- Title comes from `\title`
- The three lines below are `\author`, `\subtitle` and `\institute`
- Use `\\` inside `\author` to add more lines
- The frame must be `[plain]`: no title bar, no footer





Table of contents

```
\sapToc{Contents}{Section 1,Section 2,...}
```

- First argument: the slide title. Second: a comma-separated list of entries
- Entries are numbered automatically, two columns, row by row
- Up to six entries fit the original grid; use it inside a `[plain]` frame
- Separators alternate burgundy (left column) and teal (right column)





Content slide

A normal frame: `\begin{frame}{Title}`. The title is 26 pt bold, with the two accent bars above it. The body starts below the title and stops above the footer, which shows the short title, the short author and the slide number.

- The grey-blue banner on top and the burgundy corner with the logo are drawn by the theme
- Body text is 13 pt, lists use grey dashes
- Body width matches the original placeholder (8.4 in on a 10 in slide)





3. Lists

Itemize

- First level
 - Second level
 - Third level
- Another item

Enumerate

1. First step
2. Second step
3. Third step





Text, links and math

Regular text, **bold**, emphasis and a link: <https://github.com/pietro-nardelli/sapienza-ppt-template>. Inline math $e^{i\pi} + 1 = 0$ and a displayed equation:

$$\mathcal{L}(\theta) = -\frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N \log p_{\theta}(y_i | x_i)$$

Links are blue (#1c3678) in the light variant and cyan in the dark one.





Tables

Model	Accuracy	F1
Baseline	71.2	69.8
Ours	78.5	77.1

Use `booktabs` (load it in your preamble) for clean rules; colours follow the theme.





Incremental reveal

Standard Beamer overlays work as usual:

- \item<1-> appears on the first click

The slide number keeps counting frames, not overlays.





Incremental reveal

Standard Beamer overlays work as usual:

- \item<1-> appears on the first click
- \item<2-> appears on the second

The slide number keeps counting frames, not overlays.





Incremental reveal

Standard Beamer overlays work as usual:

- `\item<1->` appears on the first click
- `\item<2->` appears on the second
- and `\pause`, `\only`, `\uncover` are available too

The slide number keeps counting frames, not overlays.





4. Bad / Good comparison

`\sapCompare{}{y}{bad text}{good text}`: y is the distance of the top of the boxes from the top of the slide, in inches of the original 10 x 5.625 in slide.

Bad

A bad example: dense text, no structure,
hard to read from the back of the room.

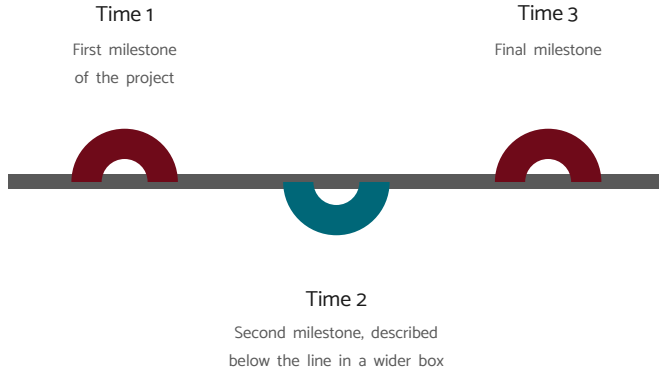
Good

A good example: short sentences, one
idea per slide, large and readable text.



Timeline

`\sapTimeline{T1}{desc 1}{T2}{desc 2}{T3}{desc 3}`: three milestones, the middle one hangs below the line.





Section slide

Subtitle goes here

`\sapSection{Title}{Subtitle}{Body}` builds a split slide: title and subtitle on the left half, free body text on the right.

It must be used inside a `[plain]` frame. The body is 11pt and may contain any text: lists, links or math.

In the dark variant the right half is lighter grey.





5. Absolute positioning

`\sapAt[options]{x}{y}{text}` puts a TikZ node with its top-left corner at (x, y) . Units are inches of the original slide (10 x 5.625), origin top-left, y pointing down.

Box at (1.0, 2.7) with a teal border.

Box at (4.5, 2.7) with a burgundy fill.

Plain text at (7.5, 3.2).





Coordinates scale with the page

- All positions are relative to the page width: `\sapU = 1` in of the original slide
- Font sizes use `\sapfs{size}{leading}`, e.g. `\sapfs{26}{30}` for a title
- So the theme works at any `aspectratio=169` paper size, not only 10 in wide
- For your own drawings use `sapcanvas`: a TikZ scope in the same units





6. Colours and fonts

Colours (usable in any TikZ/xcolor command)

- `sapTeal`, `sapBurg`
- `sapGray`, `sapSilver`
- `sapBg`, `sapText`, `sapTitle`: they change with the variant

Fonts

- Catamaran: titles and body
- Raleway: table of contents (`\sapRaleway`)
- Files are loaded from `fonts/`





Command summary

<code>\titlepage</code>	title slide
<code>\sapToc{title}{a,b,c}</code>	table of contents
<code>\sapSection{t}{sub}{body}</code>	split section slide
<code>\sapCompare{}{y}{bad}{good}</code>	Bad / Good boxes
<code>\sapTimeline</code>	three-point timeline
<code>\sapClosing{text}</code>	closing slide
<code>\sapAt[opts]{x}{y}{text}</code>	absolute text box
<code>sapcanvas</code>	TikZ scope in slide inches





Technical notes: files and units

- `beamerthemeSapienza.sty`: the whole theme (colours, fonts, templates, components)
- `fonts/`: Catamaran (.ttf) and Raleway (.otf), loaded by `fontspec` with `Path=fonts/`
- `img/`: logos, four PNGs (`logo_small` | `big_light` | `dark`)
- `\sapU` = page width / 10: one inch of the original 10 x 5.625 in slide
- `\sapPt` = page width / 722: one point of the original slide
- `\sapfs{s}{l}` sets font size and leading in `\sapPt`





Technical notes: how a slide is drawn

- `\sapmode (content, title, toc, section)` is reset to `content` at each frame start
- `background canvas` paints the fills: body, grey banner, split halves of section slides
- `background` paints bars, corner block with logo, footer text and slide number
- Both use `sapcanvas`: a TikZ overlay with `remember picture`, origin at the page top-left
- This is why two compilation runs are needed: the first one stores the node positions
- The frame title is a fixed-height box, so the body always starts at the same height





Technical notes: customisation

- Colours: change the `\definecolor` lines of the `.sty`, one block per variant
- List markers: `\setbeamertemplate{itemize item}` (grey dash, same for all levels)
- Margins: `text margin left/right = 0.798 in` of the original slide
- Font sizes: `\normalsize 13 pt`, `\small 11 pt`, `\footnotesize 9 pt`
- Requirements: XeLaTeX or LuaLaTeX, `tikz`, `fontspec`, `xcolor`, `etoolbox`
- Aspect ratio: designed for `aspectratio=169`; other ratios are not supported





References

- **Template:**
 - <https://github.com/pietro-nardelli/sapienza-ppt-template>
- **License:**
 - Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 4.0 International (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0)
- **Fonts:**
 - Catamaran and Raleway, SIL Open Font License





Thank you for the attention!

